

ANGLE LAKE MANOR NEWSLETTER

Feb 2021



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Generosity Eclipsed Caution this New Year's Day 2021



It was a shock. It was a wonder.

It was incredibly heartwarming that this New Year's Freezin for a Reason brought in an astonishing amount in donations for the Highline Food Bank even though relatively few people came!

Following a year of canceled events and banned social gathering we almost did not hold the Polar Plunge. We decided we should at least open the gates for food donations due to increased need this year. I took thank you letters around to businesses who donated refreshments and prizes last year and told them we would understand if they could not donate this year. Nonetheless, a few stepped up to contribute, so we decided to have a scaled down, socially distant plunge.



Starbucks of Normandy Park donated coffee and pastries. **Trader Joe's** donated gluten free cookies. **Grand Central Bakery** gave us huge quantities of cookies and pastries. **Wild Bird's Unlimited** offered a bird feeder with food. They even threw in Raccoon Poop (chocolate treats for humans). **Ultimate Solutions Hair Salon** not only donated 2 hair cuts but also a big check for the food bank! **Blessing Bouquet** gave a gift certificate for a floral arrangement. **Bakery Nouveau** offered a certificate for one of their chocolate cakes. **Paws in the Park** donated a gift certificate. A new donor, **Burien Spine and Sport Rehab**, gave us two massage certificates.

Azteca, always a big donor, declined this year but the manager spoke with me for several minutes about their efforts to feed and support their staff who no longer have work. He also spoke of the challenges their children face with the lockdown. It was one of the most eye opening and sober conversations I had all year and I feel that was a contribution in itself. Hopefully we can all continue to support these businesses even as we deal with our own struggles from the pandemic.

Although the raffle prizes were few, compared to past years, they were appreciated by the small crowd that turned out. We hoped to keep the number down for safety's sake and we succeeded. We had 24 attendees.

The weather was mild at 50 degrees and overcast. We did get a smattering of rain just before noon but we had a tent over the tables so we didn't get soggy food. A special thank you goes to Bill Edwards for lending us his tent and setting it up to save the day (and the food). Many thanks, also, to everyone who donated and helped put on this mini plunge.



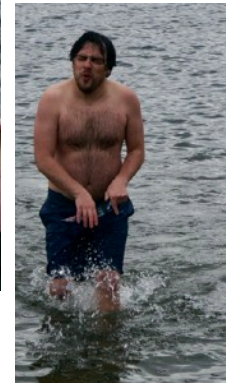
The spirit of wearing costumes was not diminished by the pared down celebration and a clear winner was determined when Fuzz Hill came as an essential medical worker in scrubs and (of course) a mask. A hilarious moment was shared when it was observed that the crown I popped onto my polar bear costume looked like the Coronavirus! We therefore had the disease and the care worker present,

representing the best and worst of last year.

Three people jumped in the lake this year and all swam to the dock and back. I got to be one of them for the first time since we began this event. With less work to be done this year, I felt I could goof off and risk the Freezin' part of our event. And you know what? I survived! I admit I was in full wetsuit attire so only my face was cold, but I was shocked that I made it! I heard myself repeating "I didn't die, I didn't die" as I emerged from the lake.

I definitely plan on plunging next year as it was fun and invigorating (and I didn't die). I imagine Cole and Artem who swam in shorts have more accurate and choice words for the experience. If you are inspired to try it yourself next year, perhaps ask them what they thought, first.

Who knows what next year will bring; hopefully we will be able to entertain the crowds we have in the past. I wonder, though, if we will ever exceed the donations that by



far outsized the number of attendees this year. To give you perspective, in 2019 we had 89 people and raised \$210 dollars and took in 210 pounds of food. Last year with 70 people we raised \$137 dollars and took in 186 pounds of food. This year with 24 people we raised \$415 dollars and took in more food than ever before. There were 12 big boxes! (we no longer measure by weight as volume is more relevant). But that is not all!

Deb Anderson brilliantly suggested we put a fundraiser on facebook before we headed down to the beach lot. Between our two posts an additional \$445 was raised!

A whopping total of \$860 and 12 boxes of food was raised for the Highline Food Bank from a nearly canceled Polar Plunge!

Should we have risked gathering outdoors in masks during a pandemic? Maybe not, but we hoped it would be worth the risk. We just never dreamed it would be so worth it.

Your Dues are Due! Here is what they'll Do!



Last year I promised your dues would make magic happen in 2020. Instead NOTHING happened. With travel and gathering shut down we turned to walking in the park and playing in our lake. The beach lot got a lot of use and offered joy and safe connection for many neighbors. I spent hours mowing and maintaining it so we could all enjoy our little slice of paradise. Your dues supported that increased upkeep and I thank you.

This year, as indoor gathering and travel is still discouraged the beach lot will, no doubt, see increased usage. In addition, our

bi-monthly meetings will need to be held outside so, in order to shelter from surprise rain storms, we need to construct a permanent rain shelter like the pavilion pictured here.

If you can swing it this year, please pay your \$40 dues before March 30th and possibly consider donating a bit extra to cover pavilion costs. We make it easy with the attached pre-addressed envelope.

It is easy to pay. Here are several ways:

1. Use the attached envelope to mail or just put in Bob's mailbox at 3303 S 194th.

1. It's okay to put it in yourself as it's the secure type that the mailman does not open.

1. Insert \$40 cash with your name & address & phone number attached.

2. Write a \$40 check (made out to ALM.) Put your address in the memo line.

2. Pay via Zelle or PayPal to Robert Simmons email: ALMCC.TREASURER@GMAIL.COM

1. Zelle: You must put your address in the "**reason (optional)**" box to be credited.

2. PayPal: Choose "**sending to a friend**". Put your address in "**add a note**" box.



Save these Dates:

Meetings 7pm:

Zoom - Feb 11th

Beach Lot:

Apr 8th,
June 10th,
Aug 12th,
Oct 14th

Kiddie Parade 10am July 4th

Cup O Cheer ?? 4pm Dec 11th

ZOOM TO THE NEXT MEETING



Topic: Angle Lake Manor Monthly Meeting
Time: Feb 11, 2021 07:00 PM Pacific Time

Join Zoom Meeting

[https://us02web.zoom.us/j/83647432257?](https://us02web.zoom.us/j/83647432257?pwd=NzI1T2pLbXBsQlZoZHJMS2hNbmlVYzZ09)
[pwd=NzI1T2pLbXBsQlZoZHJMS2hNbmlVYzZ09](https://us02web.zoom.us/j/83647432257?pwd=NzI1T2pLbXBsQlZoZHJMS2hNbmlVYzZ09)

Meeting ID: 836 4743 2257

Passcode: 337270

I will email this newsletter so you can click the link, but if I don't have your email try typing this link that I made using the link shortner, bitly. But, I'm not sure it will work.

<http://bitly.ws/bCHu> or call this number & type codes

253 215 8782 83647432257# *337270#

BEWARE... Scam Scam Everywhere!

Scams are on the rise and getting harder to discern. The number of identity theft cases more than doubled in 2020 from 2019, FTC report finds.

In the past year my husband has had a fraudulent unemployment claim filed in his name and a checking account and credit card opened in his name. If we hadn't opened what we thought was junk mail and saw checks for our 'new account' we would not have known. We both have now put a fraud alerts on our credit reports.

I just found 5 charges to my debit card on my bank statement as I was preparing year end reports. I will now check all my accounts monthly.

My cousin replied to an email claiming a \$90 charge had been made by her at Best Buy. As she had just shopped there for a \$20 item she fell for their request to call them to confirm the charge. When she did they talked her out of her bank account information with the idea they would reverse this charge (which had never happened.) When she called her bank with questions they told her she had been scammed she had to close her bank account.

AARP has lots of examples of current fraud gambits. They range from romance scams to people calling saying they are with the IRS or the police. Others call to inform you about available covid tests or vaccines. People are putting brag photos of their vaccine card on social media which is a big mistake as it has identifying info on it that can be used to steal your identity.

Links sent in Messenger or in emails from 'friends' are frequently viruses that will infect your device if you click. Often they say something about a video that has 'you' in it. Always message your friend first to ask if they sent a link before opening.

Another frequent scam is attractive men or women you don't know asking to friend you on facebook. This is usually the first step to romance scams. Never friend someone you don't know (even if they are a prince or a general or a doctor.)

Take a few minutes to see AARP's excellent resources including a hot line to call to report fraud or scams.

<https://www.aarp.org/money/scams-fraud/#oi/?intcmp=AE-SCM-FRD-FRC>.

Check out our webmaster, Val Vavrik's, heartwarming video of the polar plunge. It was so emotional to be together again after a year of alone-ness and Val captured the sentiment perfectly. It had me in tears.

<https://youtu.be/8Pp2VVA5HSE>